



ASSEMBLY
Elections 08

TO-LET

What is the Janata Party of liquor and aviation baron and former MP Vijay Mallya doing in the J&K elections? It is just a fortnight before the first phase of polls and the campaign is mainly restricted to drawing rooms. So far, no political party has ventured out for public rallies amid the total absence of enthusiasm among



Home Truth



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

It was a typical desert storm which broke as soon as the Congress released its list of 146 candidates. The list, which seems to favour former chief minister Ashok Gehlot, had veteran Congress leader Parasram Maderna fuming. He immediately dashed off a letter to Congress chief Sonia Gandhi claiming that the powerful Jat community had been ignored. Sonia has now asked that the list be redrawn. The Jats dominate over 30 constituencies and affect 70 others. Moral: Gehlot needs to win over his own partymen before he can win the state.

by Rohit Parihar

ASHOK GEHLOT
WITH TICKET-
SEEKERS AT HIS
HOUSE IN JAIPUR



SAURABH SINGH

44
of the 90 BJP
candidates in
Chhattisgarh
want the
party's poster-
boy Modi to
campaign.

**JANATA PARTY
APPEAL**
To interested candidate for
Assembly Election (J&K)

CONTACT
Urgently Required 20
People, Kashmiri
Muslim of Habba-
Kadal constituency for
Election Campaigning
Cell No:- 9797553020

Dr. Vijay Mallya
National working press
Chairman U.S. Group I
Conti
State Pri
Som Nath
941918

voters bordering on hostility. With not too many candidates keen to face the voters, some political parties have been running advertisements in local dailies asking for candidates and campaigners. The parties are promising them security, free accommodation and loads of money. In Mallya's case, even frequent flyer miles perhaps.

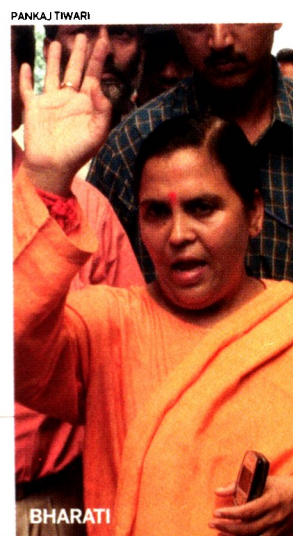
by Aljaz Hussain



One Sadhvi to Another

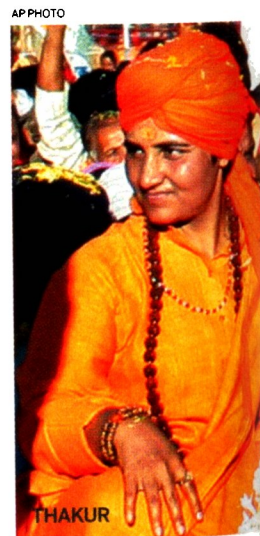
Trust Uma Bharati not to let such an opportunity slip by. Seizing the chance to underscore its hardline Hindutva credentials, Bharati's Bharatiya Janshakti, which is aiming to play the spoiler for the BJP in the coming state polls, has offered Sadhvi Pragya Thakur a party ticket to contest the polls. The BJP too has come out in defence of the Sadhvi but it looks like it's been trumped by its own saffron card.

by Ambresh Mishra



PANKAJ TIWARI

BHARATI



AP PHOTO

THAKUR